

Max Stammel, LHP, Virginia

2026 Stats: 7.55 ERA/1.661 WHIP/56 IP/62 K/28 BB/2.21 K:BB

6-3, 190

Metrics

FB: 91.4/17.2 IVB/-14.8 HB/-4.12VAA/5.4relH/6.1ext/21.9 AA/35.7% zone/40.2% usage/2350 rpm

CT: 85.4/6.6 IVB/0.5 HB/-5.6 VAA/13.9 AA/33.6% zone/11.9% usage/2360 rpm

CB: 78.6/-5.5 IVB/6.3 HB/-8.03 VAA/18.3 AA/14.7% zone/3.2% usage/2260 rpm

SL: 79.3/4.1 IVB/9.3 HB/-7.07 VAA/9.8 AA/39.4% zone/9.4% usage/2410 rpm

CH: 80.3/7.4 IVB/-20.9 HB/-6.63 VAA/11.4 AA/25.6% zone/35.3% usage/2230 rpm

Write-up

A deceptive left-hander with a compact frame and an unorthodox five-pitch mix, Stammel attacks hitters through sequencing and movement rather than overpowering velocity. He features a riding fastball at the top of the zone before attacking with both a cutter and slider to right-handed hitters while leaning heavily on an excellent fading changeup against righties. The arsenal is deeper than most college starters, but no single breaking ball consistently serves as a true out pitch. His ability to command multiple offerings and keep hitters from sitting on any one shape gives him starter traits, though sharpening one of the breaking balls into a more consistent finisher would elevate the profile. As currently constructed, Stammel projects as a pitchability starter capable of turning lineups over through deception and sequencing.

The FB is the anchor of the arsenal, sitting around 91 mph with above-average ride and a flat -4.12 VAA. The pitch consistently plays best in the upper third of the strike zone where the vertical carry allows it to miss barrels despite average velocity. Stammel showed confidence locating it to both sides of the plate, particularly out away from the hands against right-handed hitters, generating over a 30% whiff rate while collecting the highest swing-and-miss total among his fastballs. When he stayed above the belt, hitters consistently swung underneath the pitch, though occasional misses over the heart of

the plate limited its overall effectiveness. The shape is comfortably above average and gives him a reliable foundation to build the rest of the arsenal around. 50/55 pitch

The CT bridges the gap between the fastball and slider, arriving in the mid-80s with short glove-side movement and additional ride. Stammel consistently landed the cutter around the edges of the strike zone, particularly down and away to left-handed hitters while showing enough feel to backfoot righties. The pitch generated solid chase numbers despite only average swing-and-miss rates, functioning more as a weak-contact and strike-stealing offering than a true finisher. The velocity separation off the fastball allows it to disrupt timing without sacrificing command, making it an important piece of his sequencing. 45/50 pitch

The CB is used sparingly as a change-of-pace offering. Sitting in the upper 70s with above-average depth and limited glove-side movement, it provides a distinctly different visual than the rest of the arsenal. The pitch flashes enough shape to steal an occasional strike early in counts, but Stammel rarely relied on it in leverage situations and showed inconsistent feel for locating it. Given the depth already present on the slider and changeup, the curveball currently profiles as a show-me pitch rather than a meaningful swing-and-miss weapon. 40/45 pitch

The SL is a shorter, firmer breaking ball that gives Stammel another look against left-handed hitters. The movement profile is relatively balanced, pairing moderate depth with modest sweep while sitting just under 80 mph. He showed the ability to land it for strikes early in counts, but the pitch lacked enough velocity or bite to consistently finish hitters. Tightening the shape or adding another tick of velocity would allow it to better separate from the cutter while creating a more reliable put-away option. As it stands, it functions as a complementary offering that helps diversify the repertoire. 40/45 pitch

The CH is the best secondary in the arsenal and the clear weapon against right-handed hitters. Thrown roughly ten miles per hour off the fastball, it features heavy fade with excellent velocity separation and enough depth to consistently disappear beneath barrels. Stammel demonstrated advanced feel for locating the pitch down and arm side, repeatedly getting it beneath the zone where hitters expanded aggressively. The pitch generated outstanding swing-and-miss rates, accumulating 70 whiffs against

RHH through the season, while maintaining enough strike-throwing ability to keep hitters honest in fastball counts. The movement profile, command, and confidence to throw it in any count give the changeup legitimate above-average projection and make it the pitch that elevates his starter profile.

55/60 pitch